STEPHEN JONES, ESQ.
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Attorney for Plaintiff

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
CENTRAL DISTRICT OF CALIFORNIA

JOHNNY DENZEL SANTEE, Plaintiff, vs. ACCURATE BACKGROUND, INC., Defendant,	No. 8:25-cv-02447-FWS-JDE Judge Fred W. Slaughter

AFFIDAVIT OF ATTORNEY STEPHEN JONES

Before me, the undersigned notary, on this day personally appeared Stephen Jones, a person whose identity was verified by me. After I administered an oath to affiant, the affiant declared:

1. "My name is Stephen Jones. I am over twenty-one (21) years of age. I am of sound mind and have never been convicted of a felony or a crime involving moral turpitude. I am fully competent to testify to the matters set forth herein. The factual matters set forth herein are within my personal knowledge and are true and correct.

2. I am an attorney at FCRA Attorneys PLLC (formerly Jaffer & Associates, PLLC) ("Jaffer Law") and am counsel of record for Plaintiff Johnny Santee ("Plaintiff') in connection with the above-referenced matter.

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3. Plaintiff retained my services and those of Jaffer Law to represent Plaintiff in the pursuit of this lawsuit. Plaintiff agreed to pay reasonable and necessary attorneys' fees for Jaffer Law's services.

4. I graduated from the University of Kansas School of Law in 2014 and have been admitted to practice in the state of Texas since April 2015 and the state of California since May 2025. Since I began practicing law, I have primarily been engaged in consumer and collections litigation matters. I practice primarily in complex Fair Credit Reporting Act, Fair Debt Collection Practices Act, California's Consumer Credit Reporting Agencies Act, and the Texas Debt Collection Act, including disputes of the nature litigated in this matter. I am familiar with the usual and customary work performed in representing parties in disputes in this case, and most of my practice over the last two years has been devoted to such disputes. I have litigated many federal cases involving consumer protection matters.

5. I am also familiar with the legal services rendered in connection with this case, the necessity of such services and the reasonable charge for those services, having personally performed or supervised the work of others performing those services. I have also participated in the preparation and/or review of Jaffer Law's invoices for attorneys' fees and costs throughout the duration of this case. On behalf of Plaintiff in connection with this litigation, I, or another Jaffer Law attorney, performed the following services in pursuing Plaintiff's claims against Accurate Background, Inc., communicated with Plaintiff or his representatives regarding the facts of this case, and recommended courses of action; drafted or reviewed the original Complaint; researched legal issues; and drafted Plaintiff's documents filed with the Court.

6. In determining the reasonableness of the fees for the services Jaffer Law rendered herein, I have considered the following standards set forth in California Rules of Professional Conduct, Rule 1.5 and California Business & Professions Code §§ 6147–6148: the time and labor required; the novelty and difficulty of the questions presented; the skill required to perform the legal services properly; the preclusion of other employment due to acceptance of the case; the customary fee charged in the locality for similar legal services; whether the fee is fixed or contingent; the time limitations imposed by the client or the circumstances; the amount involved and the results obtained; the experience, reputation and ability of the attorneys; and the nature and length of the professional relationship with the client.

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7. Preparation and filing of the Complaint, and related legal work required approximately 10.5 hours of work conducted by myself, whose hourly rate is $495.00 and billed at quarter-hour increments and 8 hours of work done by the administrative staff, whose hourly rate is $195.00 and billed at quarter-hour increments. Court filing costs and service fees totaled $480. While working on these matters, I was precluded from working on other matters during the time spent on this matter. There was no unusual skill required to research, prepare and file the motion. A review of the record demonstrates an appropriate level of competence and expenditure of time and effort by me.

8. Through January 8, 2026, as a direct result of Jaffer Law's representation in this case, Plaintiff has incurred attorneys' fees in the amount of $6,757.50, including work in progress. Thus, the reasonable and necessary attorneys' fees Plaintiff has incurred and will incur through entry of judgment total $6,757.50. I have reviewed the hours billed by Jaffer Law considering my own experience and observations and my review of and work on this file. ***Exhibit B*** reflects summaries of the total number of billable hours spent by Jaffer Law professionals involved in this lawsuit. The attached billing records in Exhibit B summarize the fee bills maintained by Jaffer Law in the ordinary course and scope of business, and it was the regular practice of Jaffer Law's business for Jaffer Law, or an employee of the firm, to make these records, transmit these records, or oversee these records: and these records were made at or near the time of such record or reasonably soon thereafter by a person with knowledge of the information contained therein. The data summarized in Exhibit B was entered by either (a) the attorney who performed the tasks, or (b) the accounting or other Jaffer Law personnel who personally reviewed the fee bills and approved charges for these costs. Furthermore, as lead counsel for Plaintiff in this matter, I am one of the custodians of records for these documents and am one of the people responsible for causing the fee bills to be made and am responsible for the entries contained therein.

9. Based upon the nature of this case, my experience, as well as my familiarity with the work performed in this case, including the review of all the pleadings, exhibits and/or billing records, based upon my knowledge of similar cases, and based on the average hourly billable rate, which reflects all applicable discounts, it is my opinion that reasonable and necessary attorneys' fees for the legal services to prepare for and pursue this cause would be a total of $6,757.50.

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Further affiant sayeth not.

[SIGNATURES ON NEXT PAGE]

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VERIFICATION

Stephen Jones

Stephen Jones

State of Texas

County of Collin:

SWORN TO AND SUBSCRIBED before me this 8 day of January, 2026 by Stephen Jones who has produced Drivers License as identification.

Audrey Lynn Cate

Notary Public, State of Texas

AUDREY LYNN CATE
Notary ID #135101770
My Commission Expires
September 20, 2028

Print Name: Audrey Lynn Cate

My Commission Expires: September 20, 2028

Doc ID: 0bcf3cc800e31dffb45e3020483eef5ff1593e21

Dropbox Sign

Audit trail

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